arrive from distant places to see the Great Stupa. As with the older stupas at Sanchi and Bharhut, its relief sculpture depicts scenes from the Jataka tales and amorous couples dancing or embracing, symbolizing fertility and auspiciousness. But unlike the older stupas, it also portrays the Buddha in human form and depicts the iconic events of his life—birth, renunciation, enlightenment, first sermon, death—and other inspirational or enchanting legends.



Figure 4. The Great Stupa of Vijayapuri

Further east we find the largest monastery in the city (excavated by T.N. Ramachandran in 1938 and later transplanted at Anupu; archaeologists named it after Nagarjuna), attracting student monks from far and wide (for this reason, it is now, rather exaggeratedly, called a ‘university’). In its residential wing, one cell has a big limestone urn containing two teeth (archaeologists believe they belonged to Acharya Nagarjuna, who may have